

GUILDS: ARCANE, FAITH & STEEL

GUILDS: ARCANE, FAITH & STEEL IS A settlement-scale NPC supplement for 5e that explores the organized institutions controlling magic, religion, and martial discipline within a functioning city. Instead of presenting these classes solely as wandering adventurers, this book treats them as structured guild authorities responsible for training, licensing, enforcement, and doctrine.

Each ladder represents a formal hierarchy rather than a band of heroes. Apprentices, investigators, instructors, and senior authorities enforce standards within their respective institutions. These characters are not designed to roam the wilderness seeking treasure. They exist to regulate knowledge, maintain doctrine, and impose order within a community.

The intent of this product is to provide grounded NPC roles suitable for urban campaigns, political intrigue, and institutional conflicts. The creatures in this supplement are intentionally restrained in power compared to typical adventuring parties. They represent bureaucratic authority, trained specialists, and disciplined officials rather than world-shaking champions.

Cultural detail is intentionally light. Whether these guilds cooperate, compete, or secretly undermine one another is left to the GM. A wizard council might resent temple oversight, a knightly order might enforce doctrine against the will of priests, or arcane regulators may restrict magic that religious leaders consider sacred. These stat blocks provide the framework. How the institutions interact is your story to tell.

THE ARCANE GUILD

The Arcane Guild regulates magical education, licensing, and enforcement within the city. Spellcasting is treated as a controlled profession rather than a personal talent. Apprentices must train under recognized instructors, licensed wizards are expected to follow guild doctrine, and unauthorized magic invites investigation.

Arcane encounters emphasize controlled spellcasting, investigation of magical activity, and enforcement of magical law. Guild spellcasters are disciplined practitioners who rely on preparation, regulation, and structured magical authority rather than chaotic experimentation.

THE FAITH GUILD

The Faith Guild represents organized religious authority. Temples maintain doctrine, guide public worship, and enforce the moral codes recognized by the city. Clergy and holy warriors work together to preserve spiritual order while protecting sacred sites and followers.

Faith encounters emphasize divine authority, protective magic, and disciplined religious structure. Priests and temple officials rarely seek conquest, but they will enforce doctrine and defend the sanctity of their faith when challenged.

THE STEEL GUILD

The Steel Guild governs martial training and the professional warrior class within the city. Fighters serve as instructors, security forces, and disciplined combat specialists trained through formal guild structures rather than battlefield survival alone.

Steel encounters emphasize coordination, discipline, and martial leadership. These warriors represent organized military authority within the settlement, maintaining training halls, overseeing tournaments, and commanding forces when the city calls for defense.

ARCANE GUILD ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Arcane Page	0	Young apprentice beginning formal magical study under guild supervision.
Licensed Wizard	1	Recognized practitioner authorized to cast and practice magic within the city.
Arcane Specialist	2	Investigative mage trained to analyze magical phenomena and irregular spellcasting.
Spell Auditor	3	Arcane law enforcer responsible for investigating and suppressing illegal magic.
Archmagister	5	Senior wizard authority overseeing magical doctrine and guild governance.

FAITH GUILD ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Temple Acolyte	0	Novice religious assistant responsible for temple duties and early spiritual training.
Ordained Cleric	1	Fully initiated priest authorized to perform rituals and guide worship.
Holy Knight	2	Sacred warrior serving as the militant protector of the temple and faithful.
Doctrine Inquisitor	3	Religious investigator ensuring adherence to doctrine and rooting out heresy.
High Prelate	5	Senior spiritual authority guiding temple policy and religious governance.

STEEL GUILD ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Training Squire	0	Young martial trainee undergoing disciplined guild combat instruction.
Guild Fighter	1	Professional warrior serving as a guard, instructor, or guild enforcer.
Arena Veteran	2	Seasoned combatant hardened through repeated martial contests.
Field Captain	3	Battlefield leader coordinating disciplined fighters in organized formations.
Grand Marshal	5	Supreme martial authority directing guild strategy and military command.

ARCANE SPECIALIST

Medium humanoid (any), any alignment

Armor Class 11

Hit Points 32 (5d8 + 10)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)	11 (+0)

Skills Arcana +5, Investigation +5, Perception +3

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages Common plus two others

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Conclave Authority. This humanoid has advantage on Intelligence (Arcana) checks related to identifying spells, magical devices, and arcane disturbances within the city.

Spellcasting. This humanoid is a spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 13, +5 to hit with spell attacks). It requires no material components.

- **Cantrips (at will):** *mage hand, prestidigitation, fire bolt*
- **1st level (3 slots):** *detect magic, magic missile, shield, identify*

ACTIONS

Quarterstaff. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +1 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d6 -1) bludgeoning damage.

- This wizard specializes in practical arcane tasks such as wards, magical detection, and investigation.
- It attempts to control distance and defend itself with spells rather than enter melee.
- Arcane Specialists are often sent to examine magical disturbances or oversee licensed spellcasting.



ORDAINED CLERIC

Medium humanoid (any), any alignment

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 27 (5d8 + 5)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	11 (+0)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	15 (+2)	13 (+1)

Skills Insight +4, Religion +2, Persuasion +3

Senses passive Perception 12

Languages Common plus one other

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Sacred Authority. This humanoid has advantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks made when dealing with temple followers or enforcing religious customs.

Spellcasting. This humanoid is a spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 12, +4 to hit with spell attacks).

- **Cantrips (at will):** *guidance, sacred flame, thaumaturgy*
- **1st level (3 slots):** *bless, cure wounds, command*

ACTIONS

Mace. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target.

Hit: 4 (1d6 + 1) bludgeoning damage.

- This priest administers temple duties, healing rituals, and public worship.
- It uses divine magic to support allies and discourage violence.
- In combat it protects followers while invoking divine power against enemies.



GRAND MARSHAL

Medium humanoid (any), any alignment

Armor Class 20 (plate, shield)

Hit Points 95 (10d8 + 50)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	12 (+1)	20 (+5)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Str +7, Con +8

Skills Athletics +7, Insight +5, Perception +5, Persuasion +5

Senses passive Perception 15

Languages Common plus one other

Challenge 5 (1,800 XP)

Commanding Presence. Allied Fighter Compact members within 30 feet who can see or hear this humanoid gain a +2 bonus to attack rolls.

Unshakable Discipline. This humanoid has advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This humanoid makes two Longsword attacks.

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) slashing damage.

- This officer commands the Fighter Compact's forces and oversees major contracts.
- It rarely enters battle alone and typically leads disciplined groups of fighters.
- In combat it maintains formation, directing allies to overwhelm enemies through coordinated strength.



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